

LAK Precision

Lee Ann Madissoon — Kaarel Kivisalu

July 27, 2026

v1.6.1

Contents

Glossary.....	4
1 General principles.....	5
2 Constructive and competitive bidding.....	6
2.1 List of Openings.....	6
2.2 1♣.....	6
2.2.1 1♣—1♦.....	7
2.2.2 1♣—1♥.....	7
2.2.3 1♣—1♠—2♠.....	7
2.2.4 1♣—1♣—2♥.....	7
2.2.5 1♣—(DBL)—.....	8
2.2.6 1♣—(DBL or bid)—PASS/RDBL—(bid).....	8
2.2.7 1♣—(1X or 2X).....	8
2.2.8 1♣—(3X or 4X).....	9
2.2.9 Waiting 2♣.....	9
2.3 1♦.....	9
2.3.1 Interference over 1♦.....	9
2.3.2 1♦—1♥.....	10
2.3.3 1♦—1♠.....	11
2.3.4 1♦—(DBL).....	11
2.3.5 1♦—(1♥).....	12
2.3.6 1♦—(1♠).....	12
2.3.7 1♦—(1♣).....	12
2.4 1♥.....	12
2.5 1♠.....	13
2.6 1♣.....	13
2.6.1 1♣—2♣—2♦.....	14
2.6.2 1♣—2♣—2♥.....	14
2.6.3 1♣—2♣—2♠.....	14
2.6.4 1♣—2♣—(DBL).....	14
2.6.5 1♣—2♦—2♥.....	15
2.6.6 1♣—2♥—2♠.....	15
2.6.7 1♣—2♠.....	16
2.6.8 1♣—2♣.....	16
2.6.9 1♣—3♣.....	16
2.6.10 1♣—(2♣).....	16
2.6.11 1♣—(2X not ♣).....	17
2.7 2♣.....	17
2.7.1 2♣—2♦.....	17
2.8 2♦.....	18
2.8.1 2♦—2♣.....	18
2.9 2♥.....	18
2.10 2♠.....	19
2.11 2♣.....	20
2.12 3♣.....	20
2.13 Conventions common for multiple opening bids.....	21
2.13.1 1X—1Y—1Z.....	21
2.14 Slam Bidding.....	21
2.14.1 Kickback Roman Keycard Blackwood.....	21
2.14.2 Is it Kickback?.....	22
2.14.3 Serious 3NT.....	22
3 Defensive bidding.....	23

3.1	Takeout Doubles.....	23
3.2	Against Strong 1♣.....	23
3.3	Against 1X natural.....	23
3.3.1	(1M)—PASS—(2M)—DBL.....	23
3.3.2	(1M)—DBL.....	23
3.3.3	(1M)—DBL—(2M).....	24
3.4	Against 1♦ precision.....	24
3.5	Against 1♠.....	24
3.6	Against 2m majors.....	24
3.7	Against weak 2X.....	25
3.8	Against precision 2♣.....	25
3.9	Against 2♠ minors.....	25
3.10	Against weak 3X.....	26
3.11	Against weak 4m.....	26
3.12	Against weak 4♥.....	26
3.13	Against weak 4♠.....	26
4	Carding.....	27
4.1	Leads.....	27
4.2	Discards.....	28

Glossary

♣♦♥♠○	clubs, diamonds, hearts, spades, notrump
DBL	double
RDBL	redouble
$X/Y/Z$	unspecified suit that does not change in a bidtable
M	major
m	minor
MM	both majors
mm	both minors
oM	other major
om	other minor
nat	natural
BAL	balanced
unBAL	unbalanced
(xyzw)	fluid distribution
xyzw	exact distribution
PRE	preemptive
NF	non-forcing
F1	forcing for 1 round
INV	exactly invitational
INV ⁺	at least invitational
FX	forcing until X
GF	game force
SI	slam interest
ST	slam try
P/C	pass or correct
LMH	low, middle, high
flag	sets suit as a trump
R	relay/next bid
RKC	Roman Keycard Blackwood
KRKC	Kickback Roman Keycard Blackwood
XYZ	convention after 1X (not ♣)—1Y—1Z sequence
COG	choice of games
NV	non-vulnerable
VUL	vulnerable
MIN	minimum
MAX	maximum

1 General principles

Unless otherwise specified, the following general principles apply to all constructive, competitive and defensive bidding:

- The first naturally bid suit is (at least) a 5-card suit.
- The second suit bid is (at least) a 4-card suit.
- With two 5-card suits, bid the higher one first.
- With two 4-card suits, bid the lower one first (the one you can bid at a lower level).
- A new suit bid by responder is forcing for one round (F1), except when their strength is limited from above (e.g. they have previously passed).
- A natural $\clubsuit$ bid is not forcing.
- A jump is always weak and pre-emptive when it can be weak (it is your first bid or you have previously only passed).
- A jump is strong (maximum hand if your strength is limited; F1 if it is not) when it cannot be weak (you have already shown some points) or when there have already been two consecutive passes before you (then there is no point in pre-empting, because your pass would end the auction).
- Repeating your own suit is not forcing. Repeating it with a jump is forcing.
- Repeating your own suit in a free position (partner's last bid was not forcing or an opponent intervened), in a game-forcing (FG) situation, or higher than the nearest $\clubsuit$ bid shows the suit to be one card longer.
- Repeating your own suit after partner's forcing bid, below the nearest $\clubsuit$ bid, does not promise extra length, but instead shows a weaker hand (e.g. $1\heartsuit-2\clubsuit-2\heartsuit$).
- Fourth-suit forcing: if three suits have been bid naturally by our side, bidding the fourth suit is artificial and forcing (FG).
- A game bid is generally sign-off.
- Supporting partner's suit below game is usually invitational. It is not invitational after partner's pre-emptive bid (it is pre-emptive) and not in an FG situation (where it shows a stronger hand than jumping to game).

Unless otherwise specified, in competitive and defensive bidding:

- Responder's bids at 1-level and 3-level are F1.
- Responder's bids at 2-level are non-forcing (except cuebids).
- $\clubsuit$ promises a stopper in opponent's suit.
- 2-level cuebids are at least invitational, and if partner has bid a major also show support.
- 3-level cuebids ask for stopper, except direct cues $3\clubsuit\heartsuit$ when partner has bid a major, which shows at least invitational support.

2 Constructive and competitive bidding

2.1 List of Openings

- 1♣ 16+ unBAL or 17+ BAL
1♦ 10–15, 2+♦, denies a 5-card major unless has 6 diamonds
1♥ $\left\{ \begin{array}{ll} 10-15, 5^+♥ & 1^{\text{st}}, 2^{\text{nd}}, 4^{\text{th}} \\ \left\{ \begin{array}{ll} 8-9, 5^+♥ & 3^{\text{rd}} \\ 10-15, \text{good } 4^+♥ & \end{array} \right. \end{array} \right.$
1♠ $\left\{ \begin{array}{ll} 10-15, 5^+♠ & 1^{\text{st}}, 2^{\text{nd}}, 4^{\text{th}} \\ \left\{ \begin{array}{ll} 8-9, 5^+♠ & 3^{\text{rd}} \\ 10-15, \text{good } 4^+♠ & \end{array} \right. \end{array} \right.$
1⊙ $\left\{ \begin{array}{ll} 14-16, \text{BAL} & 1^{\text{st}}, 2^{\text{nd}} \text{ and } 3^{\text{rd}} \text{ NV} \\ 15-17, \text{BAL} & 3^{\text{rd}} \text{ VUL and } 4^{\text{th}} \end{array} \right.$
2♣ 10–15, 6+♣
2♦ 10–15, 4414/4405/4315/3415
2M $\left\{ \begin{array}{ll} 3-10 \left\{ \begin{array}{ll} 5^+M & \text{NV} \\ 6^+M & \text{VUL} \end{array} \right. & 1^{\text{st}}, 2^{\text{nd}}, 3^{\text{rd}} \\ 10-13, 6^+M & 4^{\text{th}} \end{array} \right.$
2⊙ $\left\{ \begin{array}{ll} 19-20, \text{BAL} & 1^{\text{st}}, 2^{\text{nd}} \text{ and } 3^{\text{rd}} \text{ NV} \\ 20-21, \text{BAL} & 3^{\text{rd}} \text{ VUL and } 4^{\text{th}} \end{array} \right.$
3X (0)3–9, (6)7+X, PRE
3⊙ Gambling, 7+m with AKQ, no other A or K
4m (0)3–9, (7)8+m, PRE
4M 7+M, to play
5m 8+m, to play
5M 11 tricks, missing AK trumps

2.2 1♣—

- 1♦ 0–7
1♥ 8–11, denies 5+♠, AK is sufficient
1♠ 8+, 5+♠, AK is sufficient
1⊙ 12+, 5+♥
2♣ 12+, 5+♣
2♦ 12+, 5+♦
2♥ 14+, BAL
2♠ 12+, (4441)
2⊙ asks
2⊙ 12–13, BAL
3X nat 7 weak

Passed hand responses:

- 1♦ 0–7
1♥ 8–10, 5♥
1♠ 8–10, 5♠
1⊙ 8–10, BAL
2♣ 8–10, 5+♣
2♦ 8–10, 5+♦
2♠ 8–10, (4441)
2⊙ asks
3X nat 7 weak

2.2.1 1♣—1♦—

1♥	20 ⁺
1♠	0–4
1♣	21–22/22–23
	system on
2♣	GF
2♦	waiting, generally all BAL hands
2♣	25–26/26–27
*	5 ⁺ suit
2M/3m	nat
2♣	23–24/24–25
*	nat, not GF
1♣	5–7, semiBAL
2♣	<i>Baron</i> (asking for 4-card suit)
2X	5–7, 5 ⁺ X
1♣	17–18/18–19 BAL
*	nat NF

2.2.2 1♣—1♥—

Usually no slam when opener has minimum hand (16–19).

1♠	5 ⁺ ♠
1♣	17–18 (18–19) or 24 ⁺ , BAL
2♣	5 ⁺ ♣
2♦	5 ⁺ ♦
2♥	5 ⁺ ♥
2♠	(4441)
2♣	asks
2♣	21(22)–23, BAL
3♣♦♥♠	flag, slam interest, demand cue-bids

After responder's second bid jump shift shows a splinter with support for last bid suit.

2.2.3 1♣—1♠—2♠—

2♣	5♠(332)
3♣♦♥	4 ⁺ cards
3♠	4 ⁺ ♠
3♣	to play (usually (4333) even with 4-card support)
other	cues, serious 3NT, kickback
3♣♦♥	4 ⁺ cards
3♠	6 ⁺ ♠
other	cues, serious 3NT, kickback

2.2.4 1♣—1♣—2♥—

2♠/3♣♦	4 ⁺ cards
2♣	5♥(332)
3♣♦	4 ⁺ cards
3♥	4 ⁺ ♥
3♣	to play (usually (4333) even with 4-card support)
other	cues, serious 3NT, kickback
3♥	6 ⁺ ♥
other	cues, serious 3NT, kickback

2.2.5 1♣—(DBL)—

If GF is established, further doubles are for penalty.

PASS	0–5
RDBL	6–7
1♦♥♠ 2♣	8 ⁺ , 5 ⁺ suit
1♣	8 ⁺ , BAL
2♣	<i>Baron</i> (asking for 4-card suit)
other	natural
2♦♥♠	5–7, 6-card suit
3♣♦♥♠	5–7, 7-card suit

2.2.6 1♣—(DBL or bid)—PASS/RDBL—(bid)—

PASS	17–18/18–19 semiBAL
DBL	20 ⁺
bid	16–19, 5 ⁺ cards
cue	16–19, Michaels (if opponents clearly have a single suit)
1♣	21–22/22–23, BAL, shows stopper
2♣ non-jump	21–24/22–25, BAL, shows stopper
2♣ jump	23–24/24–25, BAL, shows stopper

2.2.7 1♣—(1X or 2X)—

Trap is usually with 5 or more cards in their suit (with sure defensive tricks and unlimited strength) and is preparing to pass a reopening takeout double by opener.

If GF is established, further doubles are for penalty.

PASS	0–5 or trap	
DBL	$\begin{cases} 6–7 \\ 8^+, \text{ BAL, without stopper, GF (cue later to reveal)} \end{cases}$	always over 2X
over 1X		
PASS	penalty	
1M	4 ⁺ M, F1	
1♣	17–18 (18–19), BAL, with stopper, system on, NF	
2m	5 ⁺ cards, F1	
2X	GF	
2♣	21(22) ⁺ , BAL, system on, GF	
jump suit	6 ⁺ cards, GF	
non-jump new suit	8 ⁺ , 5 ⁺ cards, GF	
♣ bid	8 ⁺ , BAL, with stopper, GF	
cheapest ♣	<i>Baron</i> (asking for 4-card suit)	
other	natural	
2-level cue	8 ⁺ , BAL, without stopper, GF	
jump shift	5–7 with a long suit and strength in the suit	
3-level cue	3-suited hand (short in opponent's suit), GF	

2.2.8 1♣—(3X or 4X)—

PASS 0–6 (bad 7) or trap

DBL takeout

DBL 7⁺, no suit to bid below 3♣, GF

3♣ to play usually, with stopper

new suit 5⁺ cards, GF

4♣ quant (14⁺ BAL)

PASS 16–17, other bids force slam

5Y 5Y

5♣ no 5-card suit

6Y 4Y (lookig for 4–4 fit)

6Y 6⁺Y

2.2.9 Waiting 2♣

In non-fit auctions 2♣ implies a hand that has no side 5-card suit, no great 7-card suit, and no great support for partner's minor.

Example:

1♣—1♥—2♦—2♥—

2♠ 4⁺♠ (shorter than ♦), denies 3⁺♥

2♣ waiting, may have 4♣, denies 3⁺♥

3♣ 5⁺♦ 5⁺♣, denies 3⁺♥

3♦ 7⁺♦ (or 6 very good ones), denies 3⁺♥

3♥ ♥ flag, hearts is trump

3♠/4♣ splinter for hearts

4♥ a very bad raise

2.3 1♦—

1♥ 6⁺, 4⁺♥, F1

1♠ 6⁺, 4⁺♠, F1

1♣ 7–bad 11, BAL, no 4M, NF

2♣ 11⁺, (4)5⁺♣, no 4M unless GF and 6⁺♣, F1

2♦ 11⁺, (4)5⁺♦, no 4M unless GF and 6⁺♦, F1

2♥ 0–10, 5♠ 4–5♥

2♠ 11⁺, 5♠ 4–5♥, INV opposite 10–13 BAL, F1

2♣ good 11–13, BAL, no 4M, INV

3♣ INV, (6)7⁺♣

3♦ INV, (5)6⁺♦

3♥ PRE, (6)7⁺♥

3♠ PRE, (6)7⁺♠

3♣ 13–16, BAL, no 4M

4♣ 6–9, 7⁺♣

4♦ 6–9, 7⁺♦

4♥ good 7 or 8⁺♥, preemptive

4♠ good 7 or 8⁺♠, preemptive

Passed hand adjustments:

2♣ 6–9, 5⁺♣

2♦ 6–9, 5⁺♦

2♥ 6–9, 5♠ 4⁺♥

2♠ 6–9, 6♠ 4⁺♥

2.3.1 Interference over 1♦

Negative doubles are used. 2-level free bids (2♦ is a free bid) are NF. Support (re)doubles are on.

As a responder assume that opener has 10–13(14) BAL until told otherwise.

2.3.2 1♦—1♥—

(DBL)

PASS denies 3+♥, may have 4♠ if BAL/3-suiter

RDBL 3♥

1♠ 4♠

1♣ 1–2♥

2♣ 54+mm

(1♠)

PASS denies 3♥

DBL 3♥

1♣ 1–2♥, good stops

2♣ 54+mm

(1♣ nat)

DBL 12–15, 3♥

2♣ 54+mm

(2♣)

DBL 3♥

(2♦)

DBL 3♥

(2♠)

DBL 12–15, 3♥

2♣ good hand with 6♦ and stopper, NF

3♣ 55+mm

1♠ 4♠, unBAL

* XYZ

1♣ 10–13(14), no singleton, BAL, may have 4♠

* XYZ

2♣ 8+ cards in the minors, not 6♦ 4♣

2♦ 10–12, 6+♦

2♠ artificial GF

2♥ $\begin{cases} 10-13(14), 4♥, \text{BAL} \\ 10-12, 4♥, \text{unBAL} \end{cases}$

2♠ 5♠ 6+♦

2♣ 13–15, 3♥ 6+♦

3♣ puppet to 3♦, to play 3♦/3♥ or show a missing stopper for 3♣

3♦ forced

Pass/3♥ to play

3♠ missing ♣ stop

3♣ missing ♠ stop

3♦ ♦ flag GF asks n/l/h short

3♥ ♥ flag GF asks n/l/h short

3♣ to play

4♥ to play

3♣ 13–15, 55+ mm

3♦ 13–15, 6+♦

3♥ 13–15, 4♥, unBAL

2.3.3 1♦—1♠—

(DBL)

PASS denies 3⁺♠

RDBL 3♠

1♣ 1–2 ♠

2♣ 54⁺mm

(1♣ nat)

DBL 12–15, 3♠

2♣ 54⁺mm

(2♣)

DBL 3♠

(2♦)

DBL 3♠

(2♥)

DBL 12–15, 3♠

2♣ good hand with 6♦ and stopper, NF
3♣ 55⁺mm

1♣ 10–13(14), no singleton, BAL

* XYZ

2♣ 8⁺ cards in the minors, not 6♦ 4♣

2♦ 6⁺♦

2♥ artificial GF

2♥ 5♥ 6⁺♦

2♠ $\begin{cases} 10-13(14), 4♠, \text{BAL} \\ 10-12, 4♠, \text{unBAL} \\ 3451 \end{cases}$

2♣ 13–15, 3♠ 6⁺♦, BAL

3♣ puppet to 3♦, to play 3♦/3♠, or show a missing stopper for 3♣

3♦ forced

Pass/3♠ to play

3♥ missing ♣ stop

3♣ missing ♥ stop

3♦ ♦ flag GF, asks short (n/l/h)

3♠ ♠ flag GF, asks short (n/l/h)

3♣ to play

4♠ to play

3♣ 13–15, 55⁺ mm

3♦ 13–15, 6⁺♦

3♠ 13–15, 4♠, unBAL

2.3.4 1♦—(DBL)—

RDBL INV⁺

1♥ 4⁺♥

1♠ 4⁺♠

1♣ 7–11, BAL

2♣ 8⁺ cards in the minors, not 6♦ 4♣

2♦ 6⁺♦

2.3.5 1♦—(1♥)—

DBL 4♠
 1♠ 5⁺♠, F1
 1♣ nat, does not promise stopper
 2♣ 5⁺♣, F1
 2♦ 5⁺♦, F1
 2♠ preempt
 2♣ nat INV, promises stopper
 3♣ preempt
 3♦ 6⁺♦, to play
 3♥ stopper ask
 3♠ preempt
 3♣ to play
 4m preempt
 4♠ to play

2.3.6 1♦—(1♠)—

DBL 4♥
 1♣ nat, does not promise stopper
 2♣ 5⁺♣, F1
 2♦ 5⁺♦, F1
 2♥ 5⁺♥, F1
 2♣ nat INV, promises stopper
 3♣ preempt
 3♦ 6⁺♦, to play
 3♥ preempt
 3♠ stopper ask
 3♣ to play
 4m preempt
 4♥ to play

2.3.7 1♦—(1♣)—

Same as against 1♣.

2.4 1♥—

1♠ 7⁺, 4⁺♠, F1
 1♣ 7–11, no ♥ fit
 2m 4⁺m, GF
 2♥ 5–9, 3⁺♥
 2♣ 11–12 or 17⁺, 3⁺♥, F3♥
 3♣♦♠ shortness, not MIN
 3♥ MIN
 3♣ MAX, 5♥(332)
 4m MAX, 5⁺m
 4♥ MAX, 6♥(322) or 7♥(222)
 3m PRE
 3♥ 0–5, 4⁺♥
 3♠4m splinter
 3♣ 13–16, no ♥ fit, BAL
 4♥ 13–16, 3⁺♥

2.5 1♠—

1♣ 7–11, no ♠ fit
 2m 4⁺m, GF
 2♥ 11⁺, 5⁺♥
 2♠ 5–9, 3⁺♠

2♣ 11–12 or 17⁺, 3⁺♠, F3♠

3♣♦♥ shortness, not MIN
 3♠ MIN
 3♣ MAX, 5♠(332)
 4♣♦♥ MAX, 5⁺ suit
 4♠ MAX, 6♠(322) or 7♠(222)

3♣♦♥ PRE

3♠ 0–5, 4⁺♠

3♣ 13–16, no ♠ fit, BAL

4♣♦♥ splinter

4♠ 13–16, 3⁺♠

2.6 1♣—

2♣ *Stayman* $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{below INV, short } \clubsuit \\ \text{5M, INV} \\ \text{4M, INV}^+ \\ \text{54 or 64 MM, INV}^+ \end{array} \right.$

2♦ no 4⁺M

2♥ 4–5♥, may have 4♠

2♠ 4–5♠, no 4♥

2♦ transfer to ♥ $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{5⁺♥ below INV or GF} \\ \text{5♠ 5⁺♥ INV}^+ \end{array} \right.$

2♥ accept transfer

2♥ transfer to ♠ $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{5⁺♠ below INV or GF} \\ \text{6⁺♠ 5⁺♥, GF} \end{array} \right.$

2♠ accept transfer

2♠ $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{6⁺♣} \\ \text{range ask} \end{array} \right.$

2♣ $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{6⁺♦} \\ \text{55 mm, signoff} \end{array} \right.$

3♣ *Puppet Stayman*

3♦ 55 mm, GF

3♥ ♥ shortness, 54⁺ minors, GF

3♠ ♠ shortness, 54⁺ minors, GF

3♣ to play

4♣ *Gerber 1430*

4♦ *Texas* 6⁺♥ 0–3♠, transfer to ♥, no slam

4♥ *Texas* 6⁺♠ 0–3♥, transfer to ♠, no slam

4♠ bad quant

4♣ good quant

2.6.1 1 $\circ$ —2 $\clubsuit$ —2 $\diamond$ —

2 $\heartsuit$ MM, no game

2 $\spadesuit$ 3 $\spadesuit$ 2 $\heartsuit$

2 $\spadesuit$ 5 $\spadesuit$, INV

2 $\circ$ INV, may have 5 $\heartsuit$

3 $\clubsuit$ 5 $^+$ $\clubsuit$ 4M, GF

3 $\diamond$ 5 $^+$ $\diamond$ 4M, GF

3 $\heartsuit$ 5 $\spadesuit$ 4 $\heartsuit$, GF

3 $\spadesuit$ 5 $\heartsuit$ 4 $\spadesuit$, GF

3 $\circ$ to play

4 $\diamond$ *Delayed Texas*, 6 $\heartsuit$ 4 $\spadesuit$

4 $\heartsuit$ *Delayed Texas*, 6 $\spadesuit$ 4 $\heartsuit$

4 $\circ$ quant

2.6.2 1 $\circ$ —2 $\clubsuit$ —2 $\heartsuit$ —

2 $\spadesuit$ 5 $\spadesuit$, INV

2 $\circ$ 4 $\spadesuit$, INV

3 $\heartsuit$ 5 $\heartsuit$, accept

3 $\clubsuit$ 4 $\spadesuit$ 5 $^+$ $\clubsuit$, GF

3 $\diamond$ 4 $\spadesuit$ 5 $^+$ $\diamond$, GF

3 $\heartsuit$ 4 $\heartsuit$, INV

3 $\spadesuit$ cue

3 $\circ$ to play

4 $\clubsuit$ $\diamond$ cue

4 $\heartsuit$ to play

4 $\spadesuit$ RKC $\heartsuit$

2.6.3 1 $\circ$ —2 $\clubsuit$ —2 $\spadesuit$ —

2 $\circ$ 4–5 $\heartsuit$, INV

3 $\heartsuit$ 3 $\heartsuit$, accept

3 $\clubsuit$ 4 $\heartsuit$ 5 $^+$ $\clubsuit$, GF

3 $\diamond$ 4 $\heartsuit$ 5 $^+$ $\diamond$, GF

3 $\spadesuit$ 4 $\spadesuit$, INV

3 $\circ$ to play

4 $\clubsuit$ $\diamond$ $\heartsuit$ cue

4 $\spadesuit$ to play

4 $\circ$ RKC $\spadesuit$

2.6.4 1 $\circ$ —2 $\clubsuit$ —(DBL)—

PASS 4 $\clubsuit$, no 4M

RDBL good 4 $^+$ $\clubsuit$

2 $\diamond$ 4 $^+$ $\diamond$, no 4M

2 $\heartsuit$ 4–5 $\heartsuit$

2 $\spadesuit$ 4–5 $\spadesuit$, no 4 $\heartsuit$

2.6.5 1 $\heartsuit$ —2 $\spadesuit$ —2 $\heartsuit$ —

2 $\spadesuit$	$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} 5\heartsuit\ 5\text{ other, INV} \\ 5\spadesuit\ 5\heartsuit, \text{GF} \\ 6^+\heartsuit, \text{mild ST, splinter} \end{array} \right.$
2 $\heartsuit$	waiting
3 $\clubsuit$	5 $\heartsuit$ 5 $\clubsuit$, INV
3 $\diamond$	5 $\heartsuit$ 5 $\diamond$, INV
3 $\heartsuit$	5 $\spadesuit$ 5 $\heartsuit$, INV
3 $\spadesuit$	5 $\spadesuit$ 5 $\heartsuit$, ST
3 $\heartsuit$ 4 $\clubsuit\diamond$	6 $^+\heartsuit$ mild ST, LMH splinter
3 $\heartsuit$	declines INV, 3 $\heartsuit$
4 $\heartsuit$	accepts INV, 3 $^+\heartsuit$
2 $\heartsuit$	6 $^+\heartsuit$, INV to game or slam
3 $\heartsuit$	declines INV
3 $\spadesuit$	accepts INV
3 $\clubsuit$	4 $^+\clubsuit$, GF
3 $\diamond$	4 $^+\diamond$, GF
3 $\heartsuit$	6 $^+\heartsuit$, mild INV (needs 3 $\heartsuit$, MAX)
3 $\spadesuit$ 4m	void auto-splinter
3 $\heartsuit$	COG, partner expected to bid 4 $\heartsuit$ with most 3-fits
4 $\heartsuit$	strong 6/7 $\heartsuit$ hand, BAL, ST
4 $\spadesuit$	5 $\heartsuit$ (332), bad quant
4 $\heartsuit$	5 $\heartsuit$ (332), good quant

2.6.6 1 $\heartsuit$ —2 $\heartsuit$ —2 $\spadesuit$ —

2 $\heartsuit$	6 $^+\spadesuit$ 5 $^+\heartsuit$, GF
3 $\heartsuit$	$\heartsuit$ flag
3 $\spadesuit$	$\spadesuit$ flag
3 $\heartsuit$	22 majors
4M	to play
2 $\clubsuit$	4 $^+\clubsuit$, GF
3 $\diamond$	4 $^+\diamond$, GF
3 $\heartsuit$	6 $^+\spadesuit$, INV to game or slam
3 $\spadesuit$	declines INV
3 $\heartsuit$	accepts INV
3 $\spadesuit$	6 $^+\spadesuit$, mild INV
3 $\heartsuit$	COG, partner expected to bid 4 $\spadesuit$ with most 3-fits
4 $\clubsuit\diamond\heartsuit$	void auto-splinter
4 $\spadesuit$	strong 6/7 $\spadesuit$ hand, BAL, ST
4 $\heartsuit$	5 $\spadesuit$ (332), quant

2.6.7 1 $\heartsuit$ —2 $\spadesuit$ —

2 $\heartsuit$ MIN

PASS to play
 3 $\clubsuit$ 6 $^+$ $\clubsuit$, to play
 3 $\diamond$ 6 $\clubsuit$ 4 $\diamond$, GF
 3M 6 $^+$ $\clubsuit$, short M, GF
 3 $\heartsuit$ 6 $^+$ $\clubsuit$, light BAL ST
 4 $\clubsuit$ 6 $^+$ $\clubsuit$, short $\diamond$, GF
 4 $\diamond$ RKC $\clubsuit$
 4 $\heartsuit$ quant with 6 $\clubsuit$

3 $\clubsuit$ MAX

PASS to play
 3 $\diamond$ 6 $\clubsuit$ 4 $\diamond$, GF
 3M 6 $^+$ $\clubsuit$, short M, GF
 3 $\heartsuit$ was invite to 3 $\heartsuit$
 4 $\clubsuit$ 6 $^+$ $\clubsuit$, short $\diamond$, GF
 4 $\diamond$ RKC $\clubsuit$
 4 $\heartsuit$ quant with 6 $\clubsuit$
 5 $\heartsuit$ pick between 6 $\clubsuit$ /6 $\heartsuit$

2.6.8 1 $\heartsuit$ —2 $\heartsuit$ —

3 $\clubsuit$ rejects a $\diamond$ -based invite, may have MAX but 2 $\diamond$

PASS 55 mm, no game
 3 $\diamond$ to play
 3M 6 $^+$ $\diamond$, short M, GF
 3 $\heartsuit$ 6 $^+$ $\diamond$, to play
 4 $\clubsuit$ 6 $^+$ $\diamond$, short $\clubsuit$, GF
 4 $\diamond$ RKC $\diamond$
 4 $\heartsuit$ quant with 6 $\diamond$
 5 $\heartsuit$ choose 6 $\heartsuit$ or 6 $\diamond$

3 $\diamond$ 3 $^+$ $\diamond$, accepts 3 $\diamond$ -based invite, with side stops

PASS 55 mm, no game
 3M 6 $^+$ $\diamond$, short M, GF
 3 $\heartsuit$ 6 $^+$ $\diamond$, was invite to game
 4 $\clubsuit$ 6 $^+$ $\diamond$, short $\clubsuit$, GF
 4 $\diamond$ RKC $\diamond$
 4 $\heartsuit$ quant with 6 $\diamond$
 5 $\heartsuit$ choose 6 $\heartsuit$ or 6 $\diamond$

2.6.9 1 $\heartsuit$ —3 $\clubsuit$ —

3 $\diamond$ no 5M

3 $\heartsuit$ 4 $\spadesuit$

3 $\spadesuit$ 4 $\heartsuit$

3 $\heartsuit$ to play

3M 5M

2.6.10 1 $\heartsuit$ —(2 $\clubsuit$)—

if MM

* natural

else

DBL *Stayman*

* system on

2.6.11 1 $\circ$ —(2X not $\clubsuit$)—

DBL	penalty-oriented
2Y	5 ⁺ Y, below INV
2 $\circ$	<i>Lebensohl</i> (puppet to 3 $\clubsuit$)
(DBL)	
	system on
3 $\clubsuit$	forced
PASS	below INV, $\clubsuit$ suit
3Y below X	5 ⁺ Y, below INV
3X	asks 4 card M, with stopper
3Y above X	5 ⁺ Y, INV
3 $\circ$	to play, with stopper
3Y below X	5 ⁺ Y, INV
3X	asks 4 card M, no stopper
3Y above X	5 ⁺ Y, GF
3 $\circ$	to play, no stopper
4Y below X	5 ⁺ Y, GF

2.7 2 $\clubsuit$ —

2 $\diamond$	11 ⁺ , asks, INV ⁺
2 $\heartsuit$	8–11, 5 ⁺ $\heartsuit$, NF
2 $\spadesuit$	8–11, 5 ⁺ $\spadesuit$, NF
2 $\circ$	puppet to 3 $\clubsuit$ (to play or some 55 GF)
3 $\clubsuit$	forced
PASS	preemptive raise in $\clubsuit$
3 $\diamond$	5 $\spadesuit$ 5 $\heartsuit$, GF
3 $\heartsuit$	5 $\heartsuit$ 5 $\diamond$, GF
3 $\spadesuit$	5 $\spadesuit$ 5 $\diamond$, GF
3 $\clubsuit$ $\diamond$ $\heartsuit$	11 ⁺ , 6 ⁺ cards in the next higher suit, INV ⁺
transfer	decline INV (even with singleton)
other	accept INV
3 $\spadesuit$	6 $\spadesuit$ 4 $\heartsuit$ GF
3 $\circ$	to play
4 $\clubsuit$	5–9, preemptive, at least 3 $\clubsuit$ usually 4 $\clubsuit$
4 $\heartsuit$	to play
4 $\spadesuit$	to play
5 $\clubsuit$	to play

2.7.1 2 $\clubsuit$ —2 $\diamond$ —

(2M)	
PASS	MIN
2 $\spadesuit$	MAX, 4 $\spadesuit$
2 $\circ$	MAX, stopper
3 $\clubsuit$	MAX, no stopper
3 $\diamond$	MAX, nat
3 $\heartsuit$ over $\spadesuit$	MAX, nat
2 $\heartsuit$	MIN, 4 $\heartsuit$
2 $\spadesuit$	MIN, 4 $\spadesuit$
2 $\circ$	MAX, no 4-card major
3 $\clubsuit$	MIN, no 4-card major
3 $\diamond$ $\heartsuit$ $\spadesuit$	MAX, 4 ⁺ suit

2.8 2♦—

2♥ to play

2♠ 4315

2♠ to play

2♣ asks

3♣ to play

3♦ 11⁺, good 6⁺♦

3♥ 7–9, 5♥

4♥ 4♥, MAX

3♠ 7–9, 5♠

4♠ 4♠, MAX

3♣ to play

4♥ to play

4♠ to play

2.8.1 2♦—2♣—

3-card majors are shown to make responder declarer.

3♣ MIN

3♦ asks for a 3-card major

3♥ 4315

3♠ 3415

3♣ 44 majors

3♦ MAX, 44 majors, GF

3♥ sets ♥ for cues

3♠ sets ♠ for cues

3♥ MAX, 4315

3♠ MAX, 3415

2.9 2♥—

Assume 6⁺♥ unless NV vs. VUL.

2♠ INV, 5⁺♠

2♣ 14⁺, asks

(bid)

step 1 PASS

step 2 DBL/RDBL

step * next bids

3♣ MIN, bad suit

3♦ MIN, good suit

3♥ MAX, bad suit

3♠ MAX, good suit

3♣ INV, 5⁺♣

3♦ INV, 5⁺♦

3♥ 0–13, 3⁺♥, preempt

4♥ to play

2.10 2♠—

Assume 6⁺♠ unless NV vs. VUL.

2♣ 14⁺, asks

(bid)

step 1	PASS
step 2	DBL/RDBL
step *	next bids

3♣ MIN, bad suit

3♦ MIN, good suit

3♥ MAX, bad suit

3♠ MAX, good suit

3♣ INV, 5⁺♣

3♦ INV, 5⁺♦

3♥ INV, 5⁺♥

3♠ 0–13, 3⁺♠, preempt

4♠ to play

2.11 2♣—

3♣ *Muppet Stayman* $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} 3^+M \\ 5♠3-5♥ \\ \text{not } 5♥4♠ \end{array} \right.$

3♦ 4M, no 5M

3♥ 4-5♠, asks ♠ length

3♠ 3♠4♥

3♣ 2♠4♥

4♣ 4♠, MAX

4♠ 4♠, MIN

3♠ 4♥

3♣ to play (no 4M)

4♣ 44⁺MM, SI

4♦ RKC in ♥

4♥♠ to play

4♣ RKC in ♠

4♦ 44⁺MM, no SI

3♥ no 4⁺M

3♠ transfer to 3♣ (to play)

3♣ 5♠

4♣ 55 MM, SI

4♦ RKC in ♥

4♥♠ to play

4♣ RKC in ♠

4♦ 55 MM, no SI

3♠ 5♠

3♣ 5♥

4♦ transfer to 4♥

3♦ transfer to ♥ $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} 5^+♥ \\ 5♥4♠ \end{array} \right.$

3♥

3♠ choose a game (indicating exactly 5♥)

3♣ 5♥4♠, no SI if no fit, NF

3♥ transfer to ♠, not 5♠3-5♥

3♠ 54⁺mm or 6⁺ m, at least mild ST

3♣ to play

4♣ *Gerber* 1430

4♦ 6⁺♥, ST

4♠ RKC

4♥ 6⁺♠, ST

4♣ RKC

4♣ quant

2.12 3♣—

PASS stoppers in all other suits

4♣ P/C

4♦ asks

4M 0/1 M

4♣ 22(72)

5m 0/1 other m

5♣ P/C

5♦ to play

2.13 Conventions common for multiple opening bids

2.13.1 1X—1Y—1Z—

Not used after 1♣ opening. It is on in some competitive situations (not if opponents bid after Z).

1♦—1♥—1♠—

1♦—1♥—1♣—

1♦—1♠—1♣—

1♥—1♠—1♣—

1♦—(1♥)—DBL—1♠—

1♦—(1♥)—DBL—1♣—

1♦—(1♠)—DBL—1♣—

1♣	to play
2♣	puppet to 2♦ $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{artificial invite} \\ \text{long } \diamond \end{array} \right.$
2♦	artificial GF
2♥	to play
2♠	natural
2♣	natural, denies a 5 card Y, INV
3♣	to play
3♦	5Y5♦, slam interest
3Y	6 ⁺ suit, slam interest

3♣ to play
* control for Y

double jump shift splinter for the last natural suit

2.14 Slam Bidding

2.14.1 Kickback Roman Keycard Blackwood

Without Kickback (keycards are Aces and trump K):

4♣	RKC
5♣	1/4 keycards
5♦	0/3 keycards
5♥	2 keycard, no trump Q
5♠	2 keycard, trump Q

With Kickback (X is trump):

4X + 1	KRKC
4X + 2	1/4 keycards
4X + 3	0/3 keycards
4X + 4	2 keycard, no trump Q
4X + 5	2 keycard, trump Q

Next step queries trump queen (if not known):

Y	trump Q ask
Y + 1	no trump Q
Y + 2	trump Q

Next step queries #kings (then #queens, ...):

Z	#kings ask
Z + 1	0/3 kings
Z + 2	1/4 kings
Z + 3	2 kings

2.14.2 Is it Kickback?

The answer is that if a 4-level jump bid could be construed as Kickback, and there is any way to bid that suit naturally and forcing below game, then it is Kickback.

If there are two suits, then the cheapest “impossible” bid is Kickback for the lower suit and the next “impossible” bid is Kickback for the higher suit.

2.14.3 Serious 3NT

When a major suit is trumps and slam is not yet ruled out, 3NT is not natural, but rather a waiting bid that shows a good hand in context. If you bypass 3NT, you deny a good hand in context.

Example:

1♥—2♣—2♥—3♥—

- 3♠ cue-bid, does not say whether serious or not
- 3⊙ Serious 3NT (13–15 as 1♥ was 10–15), denies a spade cue
- 4♣ cue-bid, non-serious hand (10–12), denies a space cue, min but not the pits
- 4♦ cue bid, non-serious hand (10–12), no spade or club cue
- 4♥ the worst hand (10–11), bad distribution, honour location and slam cards

3 Defensive bidding

3.1 Takeout Doubles

Equal level conversion only over 1M openings with oM and ♦, see 3.3.2.

3.2 Against Strong 1♣

DBL MM
n♣ mm

3.3 Against 1X natural

2X over 1m MM, 55⁺
2X over 1M oM and m, 55⁺
2♣ two lowest unbid suits (at least 55)

3.3.1 (1M)—PASS—(2M)—DBL—

(RDBL)

system on

2♠ 5⁺♠, below INV
2♣ *Lebensohl* (usually puppet to 3♣)

(DBL)

system on

3♣ usually forced
PASS below INV, ♣ suit
3X below M 5⁺X, below INV
3M asks 4 card oM, with stopper
3X above M 5⁺X, INV
3♣ to play, with stopper
3♦♥♠ 4♣ 18⁺, 5⁺ strong suit
3♣ 18⁺, semiBAL, with stopper
3X below M 5⁺X, INV
3M asks 4 card oM, no stopper
3X above M 5⁺X, GF
3♣ to play, no stopper
4X below M 5⁺X, GF

3.3.2 (1M)—DBL—

2♣

2♦ *Equal Level Conversion*, oM and ♦

3.3.3 (1M)—DBL—(2M)—

DBL	responsive
2♠	5 ⁺ ♠, below INV
2♣	<i>Lebensohl</i> (usually puppet to 3♣)
(DBL)	
	system on
3♣	usually forced
PASS	below INV, ♣ suit
3X below M	5 ⁺ X, below INV
3M	asks 4 card oM, with stopper
3X above M	5 ⁺ X, INV
3♣	to play, with stopper
3♦♥♠ 4♣	18 ⁺ , 5 ⁺ strong suit
3♣	18 ⁺ , semiBAL, with stopper
3X below M	5 ⁺ X, INV
3M	asks 4 card oM, no stopper
3X above M	5 ⁺ X, GF
3♣	to play, no stopper
4X below M	5 ⁺ X, GF

3.4 Against 1♦ precision

1♦ is treated as a natural 1X opening with the following exceptions. This means that ♦ is used for cue bids later even though it is not used in the first overcall.

DBL	short ♦ not needed
1♣	does not promise a ♦ stopper
2♦	natural
2♥	<i>Michaels cue</i> , 55 ⁺ ♠♥
2♣	<i>Unusual</i> , 55 ⁺ ♥♣
3♦	<i>Super-Michaels</i> , 55 ⁺ ♠♥, F1

3.5 Against 1♣

DBL	penalty
2♣	54 ⁺ MM
2♦	6 ⁺ M
2♥	5♥ + 4 ⁺ m
2♠	5♠ + 4 ⁺ m
2♣	55 ⁺ mm

3.6 Against 2m majors

DBL	4 ⁺ M
2♥	54 ⁺ mm, ♣ better
2♠	54 ⁺ mm, ♦ better

3.7 Against weak 2X

DBL	$\begin{cases} 12^+, 3^+ \text{ cards in unbid suits, shortness in } X \\ 18^+, 5^+ \text{ strong suit} \\ 18^+, \text{ semiBAL, with stopper} \end{cases}$	rebid suit rebid $\odot$
(RDBL)	system on	
2Y	5 ⁺ Y, below INV	
2 $\odot$	<i>Lebensohl</i> (usually puppet to 3 $\clubsuit$)	
(DBL)	system on	
3 $\clubsuit$	usually forced	
PASS	below INV, $\clubsuit$ suit	
3Y below X	5 ⁺ Y, below INV	
3X	asks a 4 card M, with stopper	
3Y above X	5 ⁺ Y, INV	
3 $\odot$	to play, with stopper	
3 $\diamond$ $\heartsuit$ $\spadesuit$ 4 $\clubsuit$	18 ⁺ , 5 ⁺ strong suit	
3 $\odot$	18 ⁺ , semiBAL, with stopper	
3Y below X	5 ⁺ Y, INV	
3X	asks 4 card M, no stopper	
3Y above X	5 ⁺ Y, GF	
3 $\odot$	to play, no stopper	
4Y below X	5 ⁺ Y, GF	
2Y	10–17, 5 ⁺ cards	
(3X)	DBL responsive, 10 ⁺ , length in unbid suits, no support for Y	
PASS	0–7	
3X	strong raise in Y, GF	
3Y	8–10, 3 ⁺ Y	
3Z	5 ⁺ suit, F1	
4 not Y	splinter	
2 $\odot$	14–17, semiBAL, with stopper	
3Y below X	12–17, (5)6 ⁺ cards	
3Y above X	16 ⁺ , very strong 6 ⁺ cards	
3X	stopper ask for $\odot$	
3 $\odot$	16 ⁺ , with stopper and a long-running minor	
4X	55 ⁺ , mm	
4m	55 ⁺ , m and oM (or MM over 2 $\diamond$)	
4 $\heartsuit$ $\spadesuit$ if not X	16 ⁺ strong 6 ⁺ cards	

3.8 Against precision 2 $\clubsuit$

Treat as weak 2X.

3.9 Against 2 $\odot$ minors

DBL	penalty interest in at least one minor
3 $\clubsuit$	MM, $\heartsuit$ better
3 $\diamond$	MM, $\spadesuit$ better
3 $\heartsuit$	nat
3 $\spadesuit$	nat

3.10 Against weak 3X

DBL	$\begin{cases} 14^+, 3^+ \text{ cards in unbid suits, shortness in } X \\ 18^+, 5^+ \text{ strong suit} \\ 23^+, \text{ semiBAL, with stopper} \end{cases}$	rebid suit rebid $\odot$
3Y	12–17, (5)6 ⁺ cards	
3 $\odot$	16–22, with stopper	
4X over m	55 ⁺ , MM	
4X over M	55 ⁺ , oM + m	
4m (not X)	55 ⁺ , m + M (other or unspecified)	
4M (not X)	16 ⁺ strong 6 ⁺ cards	
4 $\odot$ over M	55 ⁺ mm	

3.11 Against weak 4m

DBL	takeout
4 $\odot$	natural with stopper(s)
5m (cue)	55 ⁺ MM
other	natural

3.12 Against weak 4♥

DBL	penalty-oriented
bid	5♠ or 6 ⁺ card suit
4 $\odot$	55 ⁺ mm
other	natural

3.13 Against weak 4♠

DBL	penalty-oriented
bid	6 ⁺ card suit
4 $\odot$	takeout
other	natural

4 Carding

4.1 Leads

General style:

- Reverse attitude (low = ENC, high = DISC)
- Standard count (Hi/Lo = even)
- Attitude on A or Q (denies A)
- If needed, unblock on K, else count on K
- 1st, 3rd or 5th in suit
- 4th in NT with honour
- 2nd in NT without honour
- In partner's suit always 1st, 3rd or 5th
- 10 or 9 is always 1st or 3rd
- MUD for weak 3-counts

	Lead	In Partner's Suit
Suit	1 st /3 rd /5 th	1 st /3 rd /5 th
Notrump	4 th (2 nd without honour)	1 st /3 rd /5 th
Subsequent	1 st /3 rd /5 th	1 st /3 rd /5 th

Table 1: Opening leads style.

Card	Combination	Signal
Ace	AK(+), Ax	ATT
King	AK(+), KQ(+)	If needed unblock, else count
Queen	KQ(+), QJ(+), Qx	ATT
Jack	J10(+), Jx	Count
10	HJ10(+), 109(+), 10x	Count
9	H109(+), 98(+), 9x	Count
Hi-X	Xx, xXx	Count
Lo-X	xxXx, HxX(x), xxxX, HxxxX	Count

Table 2: Leads vs Suit.

Card	Combination	Signal
Ace	AK(+), Ax	ATT
King	AK(+), KQ(+)	If needed unblock, else count
Queen	KQ(+), QJ(+), Qx	ATT
Jack	J10(+), Jx	Count
10	HJ10(+), 109(+), 10x	Count
9	H109(+), 98(+), 9x	Count
Hi-X	Xx, xXx, xXxx(+)	Count
Lo-X	HxxX(+), HHxX(+), HxX	Count

Table 3: Leads vs NT.

	Partner's Lead	Declarer's Lead	Discarding
1	Lo = ENC	Hi/Lo = Even	odd=ENC, even=S/P
2 Suit	Hi/Lo = Even		
3	S/P		
1	Lo = ENC	Hi/Lo = Even	S/P
2 NT	Hi/Lo = Even		
3	S/P		

Table 4: Signals in order of priority.

For suit preference (S/P) a high card suggests the higher suit and a low card the lower suit.

4.2 Discards

- Italian (aka. Odd-Even) in suit. This means odd=ENC, even Hi/Lo.
- Lavinthal in NT. This means Hi/Lo.